

The X-factor

Jasprit Bumrah was once again the bowling linchpin in India's title march. He topped the wicket-taking charts with 14 scalps, including a career-best four for 15 in the decider against New Zealand.

Bumrah's average of 12.42 and his economy rate of 6.41 were the best among bowlers who bowled at least 150 deliveries in the tournament.

The 32-year-old was the most lethal in the PowerPlay, conceding at less than a run-a-ball (5.90) and picking up six wickets. However, he yielded wickets for India at the death too. Between overs 15 and 20, Bumrah nabbed six batters and operated at an economy rate of 6.50.

Bumrah was also the most proficient employer of the yorker. With five wickets at an average of 2.80 off that length, he was miles ahead of the pack, which also included Lungi Ngidi, Jason Holder, and Sam Curran.



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The 'Ax' effect

India's catching in this T20 World Cup came under immense scrutiny.

It had shelled 13 chances in the field and had a catching efficiency of 71.7 per cent till the end of the Super Eights, the worst among the eight teams in the round.

But Axar Patel grabbed

crucial catches in the semifinal against England, and did so in breathtaking fashion, to ensure India was not left to rue missed chances.

Early in the innings, Bumrah deceived Harry Brook with a slower delivery that led to the England captain fluffing

his front-footed drive in the air. Axar sprinted roughly 20 yards from the edge of the ring to deep cover and flung himself forward to snaffle the chance. His second catch of Will Jacks came when India was under pressure and England, chasing the daunting 254-run target, was no longer an improbable threat. In the 14th over, Jacks sliced a wide full toss from

Arshdeep Singh. Axar (**above**) darted to his left at deep cover to grab the ball inches inside the boundary before releasing it to Shivam Dube for a relay catch as he tumbled across the line.

"On a [flat] wicket like this one, it is important to support your bowlers and I'm glad I could do that," Axar said after India edged out England by seven runs.